

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Analyst

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Analyst with over five years of experience delivering advanced incident response, threat hunting, detection engineering, and vulnerability management within complex enterprise and managed security environments. I bring deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon, and the broader Microsoft security ecosystem. I have a proven track record of conducting proactive threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, developing high-fidelity detection analytics rules, automating Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows, and managing the full security incident lifecycle in accordance with NIST 800-61. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and I am committed to delivering proactive, intelligence-led cyber defence across modern hybrid cloud environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL analytics rules, threat intelligence correlation, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, end-to-end incident lifecycle management, MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTP) mapping, post-incident review
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry; TTP-based detection analytics
- **SOAR:** Automated playbook development, alert triage automation, orchestration workflows, enrichment pipelines
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover), Tanium
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Conditional Access, Multi-factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+)
- **Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead SOC operations for a 10,000+ user estate, overseeing alert triage, advanced incident investigation, and coordinated response across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, and Microsoft Defender platforms
- Develop and maintain detection engineering content within Microsoft Sentinel, including KQL analytics rules, threat intelligence correlations, and automated SOAR playbooks mapped to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK, formulating hypotheses from threat intelligence and hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry
- Lead major security incident investigations under the NIST 800-61 incident response framework, coordinating cross-functional response from detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review

- Administer MDE, MDI, and M365 Defender, maintaining detection policies and tuning alert fidelity for 8,000 users, including automated remediation configurations
- Drive vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, providing risk-ranked reporting and tracking remediation to closure against agreed service levels
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID and BeyondTrust PAM, maintaining identity security controls including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and least-privilege access reviews
- Develop SOAR automation for alert triage, threat enrichment, and response orchestration, driving measurable reductions in mean time to respond (MTTR)
- Maintain SOC operations aligned to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and CE+ standards, contributing to audit evidence and control reviews

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed daily alert triage and incident investigation across SIEM and EDR platforms, escalating high-severity incidents in line with response procedures and contributing to post-incident reporting
- Contributed to the rollout of MDE across 8,000 users, establishing detection baselines, automated remediation actions, and alert management policies
- Developed KQL queries within Microsoft Sentinel to hunt for indicators of compromise (IoCs) and detect attacker TTPs across endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-ranked remediation reports for infrastructure, application, and cloud workloads
- Mapped observed indicators and attacker behaviour to MITRE ATT&CK, feeding threat intelligence insights into detection rule development and hunting hypotheses
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID and BeyondTrust PAM, supporting Conditional Access policy reviews and privileged access governance
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline SOC operations and reduce manual handling of repetitive triage tasks
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and CE+ compliance activities, supporting evidence gathering and control reviews

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Monitored and investigated security events across endpoint and network security platforms for a cloud-hosted SaaS and FinTech environment, responding to threats in line with incident response procedures
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, contributing to detection policy configuration, alert triage, and incident response actions
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and collaborated with infrastructure teams to prioritise and remediate critical and high-severity findings
- Administered identity and access management controls including MFA and SSO, enforcing least-privilege access principles across the platform

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed over 40 KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, directly improving threat visibility across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry and reducing alert noise
- Led the enterprise-wide MDE rollout to 8,000 users with zero service disruption, delivering full EDR coverage, automated remediation, and real-time alert management
- Reduced MTTR to security incidents by 35% through the development of 12 SOAR playbooks covering high-volume and high-severity incident scenarios
- Identified a previously undetected persistence mechanism during a proactive threat hunting exercise, resulting in the complete remediation of a compromised privileged account chain
- Maintained ISO 27001 and CE+ compliance, contributing to evidence gathering, policy development, and control assessments across the security programme

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**

- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)